OPEN LETTER · STEVE PROTHERO · OWNER

Greenway Terraces newsletter: a call to explain decisions, costs and the solar battery

Sent 20 October 2026 · To The Executive Committee, Greenway Terraces (UP12457) · Response requested by 17 November 2026

Dear President and Committee Members,

Firstly, congratulations to our new President and Treasurer. I wish you both well in your roles.

I also want to acknowledge and thank those involved in the recent insurance work. Insurance is a significant responsibility for our Owners Corporation, and I appreciate the time and effort that has gone into addressing these matters.

I welcome the newsletter and the effort being made to improve communication with owners and residents. It is a positive initiative, and I would like to offer some constructive suggestions.

By way of background, during my career I was responsible for public relations and communications for an organisation of approximately 3,000 staff. I mention this not to boast or suggest that my views deserve special treatment, but simply to explain where my suggestions come from.

They are not merely personal preferences. They reflect established principles of effective organisational communication and lessons learned through practical experience.

Good communication reduces tension, builds confidence, encourages participation and helps bind a community together. Poor or incomplete communication can have precisely the opposite effect.

The newsletter is a good starting point, but I believe it could provide greater depth without becoming significantly longer.

In particular, I suggest that future newsletters:

- **Explain decisions, not simply announce them.** What is proposed, why is it necessary, what alternatives were considered and who authorised it?
- **Provide meaningful financial information.** What will projects cost, how will they be funded, and what savings or benefits are expected?
- **Report outcomes and progress.** What has been achieved, what remains outstanding and are projects proceeding within budget?
- **Address residents' questions.** Include a short section responding to matters of general interest raised by owners and residents.

- **Encourage genuine two-way communication.** Explain how questions can be submitted and establish reasonable expectations for receiving responses.

The proposed solar battery is a useful example. I have already raised questions about the source and ownership of the electricity, the proposed arrangements and the financial benefits. These are reasonable questions that should be answered before owners can properly assess the proposal.

I would also encourage the Committee to consider how correspondence from owners is managed. I have a considerable number of outstanding questions and requests for clarification. Acknowledging correspondence, providing reasons for decisions and responding within a reasonable period would go a long way towards building trust.

One important principle of communication is that silence should never be mistaken for agreement. Residents who do not respond to an announcement have not necessarily endorsed it. Equally, those who ask questions are not necessarily opposed to a proposal.

With 151 townhouses at Greenway Terraces, we have a substantial community with different interests, expectations and experiences. Effective communication can help bring those interests together rather than allow misunderstandings to become disagreements.

My suggestion is that the communications team consider adopting a simple standard for significant announcements: **What are we doing, why are we doing it, what will it cost, what are the benefits, and how can residents obtain further information?**

I recognise that Committee members volunteer their time and that communication places additional demands on them. These suggestions are intended to make that work more effective, not more burdensome.

Thank you again for the work being undertaken. I hope these suggestions will be received in the constructive spirit in which they are offered.

Good communication is not about ensuring everyone agrees. It is about ensuring people are informed, heard and treated with respect, even when they disagree.

Kind regards,

Stephen Prothero

Make my email shorter and sharperMake my requests more specific

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Steve Prothero · owner · https://steveprothero-cmyk.github.io/greenway-letters/l/2026-10-20-greenway-terraces-newsletter-some-constructive-suggestions/